Finding 1 - Sysmon Installation (Windows VM)

Objective

Install Sysmon with the SwiftOnSecurity configuration to capture detailed endpoint telemetry.

Steps performed

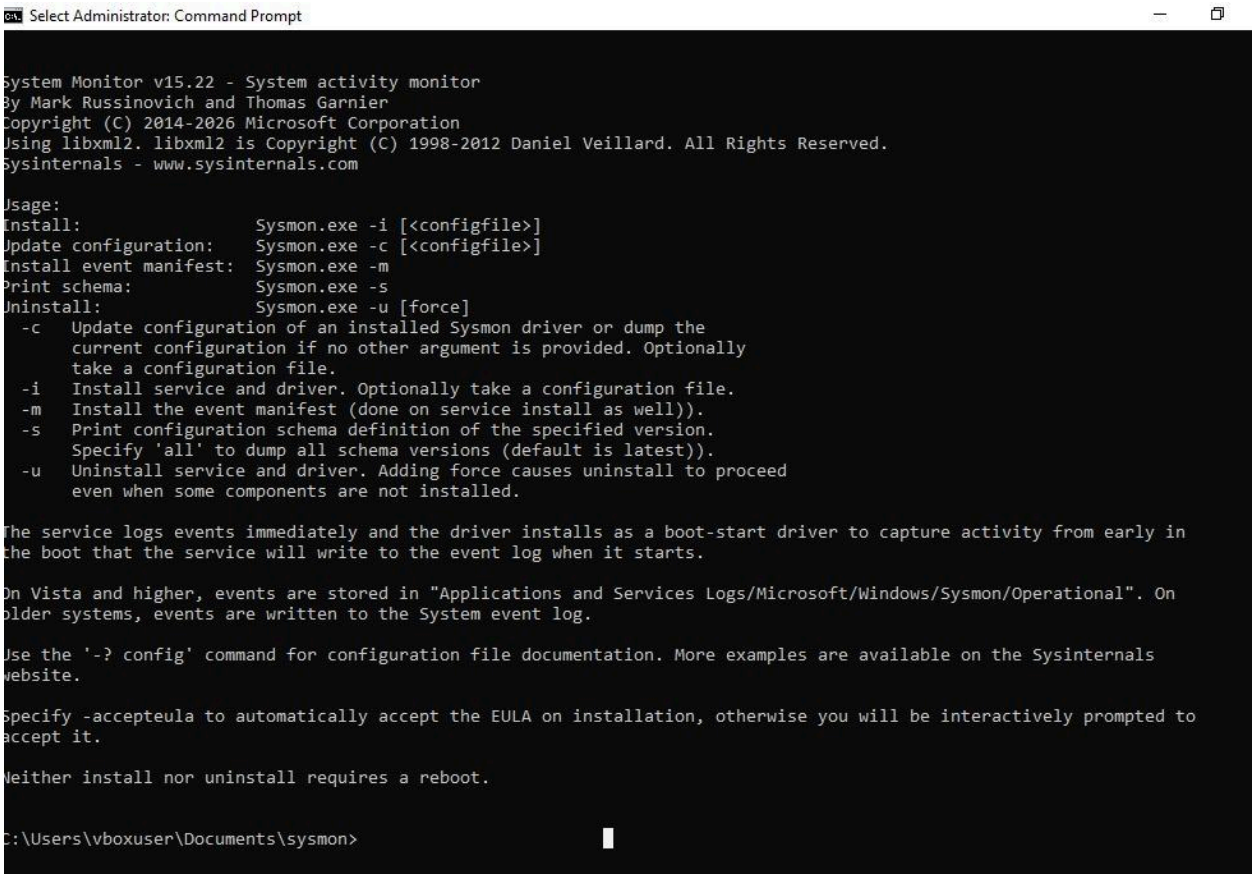
Step	Action	Command / Location
1	Downloaded Sysmon from the official Microsoft Sysinternals page and extracted it	`C:\Sysmon`
2	Downloaded the SwiftOnSecurity config into the same folder	`https://raw.githubusercontent.com/SwiftOnSecurity/sysmon-config/master/sysmonconfig-export.xml`
3	Opened an elevated Command Prompt, moved to `C:\Sysmon` and installed Sysmon	`cd C:\Sysmon` then `sysmon.exe -accepteula -i sysmonconfig-export.xml`
4	Verified in Event Viewer	Applications and Services Logs > Microsoft > Windows > Sysmon > Operational
5	Captured a screenshot showing events being recorded	See screenshots below

Useful verification commands

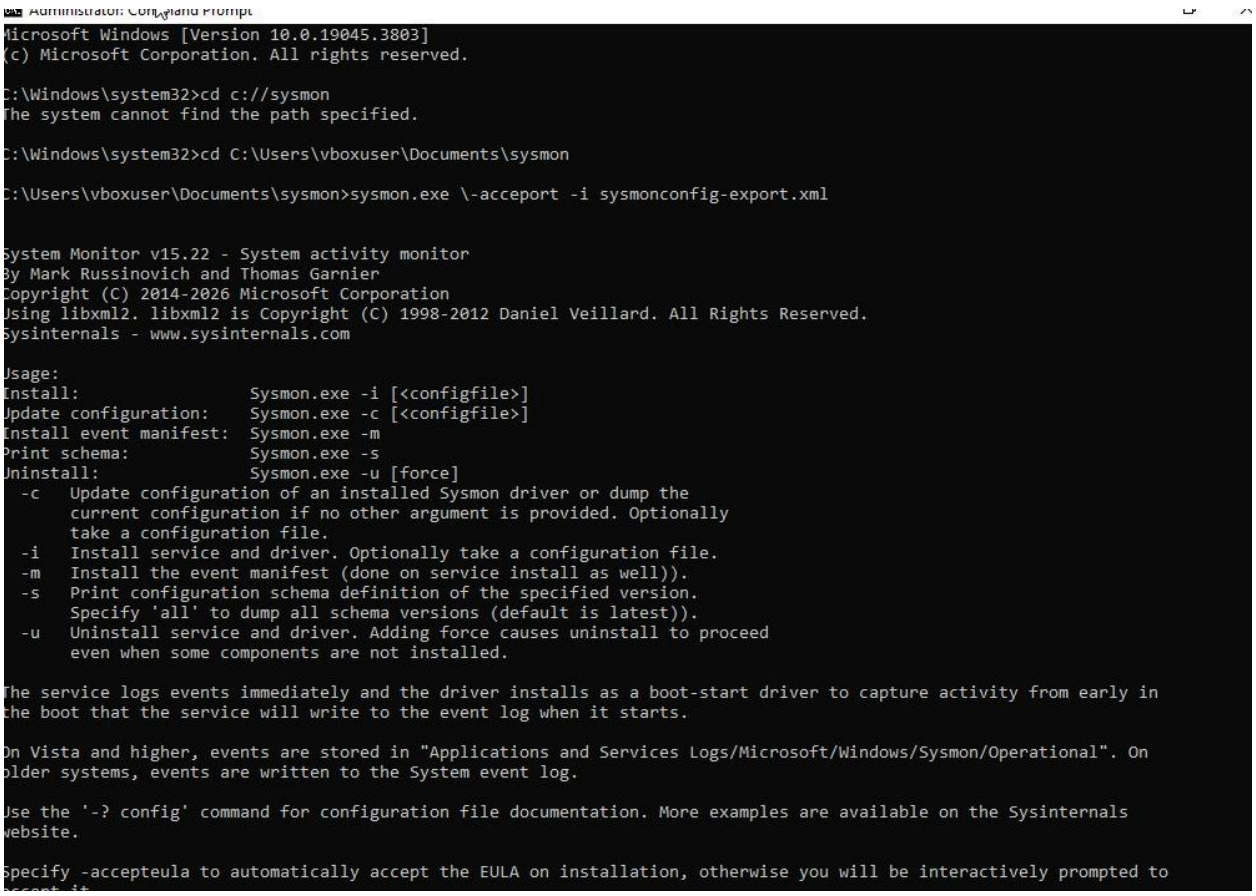
```
sc query sysmon64
sysmon.exe -c
```

Screenshots

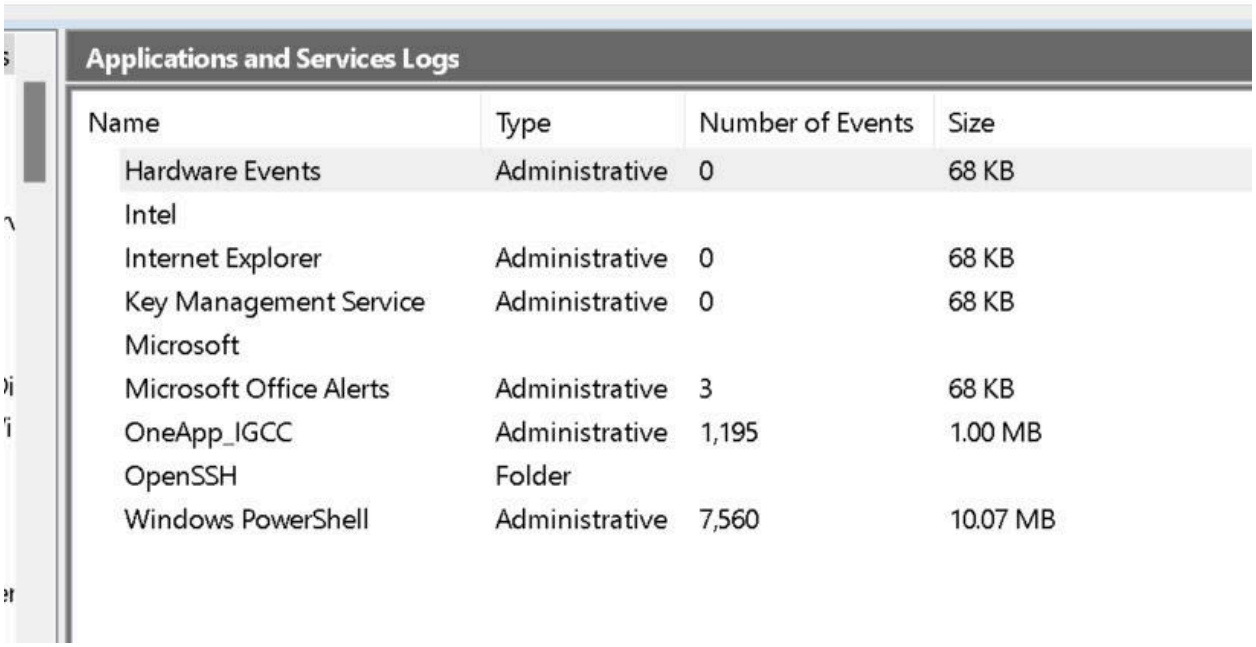
Screenshot 1.1 - Sysmon files in C:\Sysmon (executable and config)



Screenshot 1.2 - Installation command and success message in elevated Command Prompt



Screenshot 1.3 - Sysmon Operational log in Event Viewer showing events being captured



Explanation

- The SwiftOnSecurity config is a widely used, well-tuned baseline. It excludes known noisy events and keeps the events that matter for detection (process creation, network connections, file creation, registry changes, DNS queries).
- After installation, Sysmon runs as a service and driver and writes to the Operational log with every new event.
- Seeing new Event ID 1 (Process Create) entries appear confirms Sysmon is working.

SOC relevance

Sysmon adds command lines, hashes, parent processes, network connections and DNS queries that default Windows logging does not provide, enabling much faster investigation and threat hunting.